



IEP Meeting Preparation Checklist

Universal + Disability-Specific Checklists | In-Person & Virtual Meetings

Knowledge is power. Partnership is progress. Together — the IEP gets APPROVED.

MEETING INFORMATION			
Date:	_____	Time:	_____
Location / Platform:	_____	Meeting Type:	☐ In Person ☐ Virtual ☐ Phone
School:	_____	District:	_____
Child's Name:	_____	Grade:	_____
Case Manager:	_____	Your Name:	_____

■ **Virtual Meeting Tips:** Test your audio/video 10 min before. Have documents open on a second screen or printed. Use chat to submit written questions. Record the meeting if your state allows (check your state's recording laws first). Request that all participants identify themselves at the start.

ATTENDEES — Check everyone present and note their role

☐ Parent/Guardian	☐ Special Ed Teacher	☐ General Ed Teacher
☐ Case Manager	☐ LEA Representative	☐ School Psychologist
☐ Speech Therapist (SLP)	☐ Occupational Therapist	☐ Physical Therapist
☐ School Counselor	☐ Behavior Specialist/BCBA	☐ AT Specialist
☐ Transition Coordinator	☐ Outside Advocate/Attorney	☐ Interpreter

Additional attendees / notes:

UNIVERSAL CHECKLIST — Every IEP Meeting

1 WEEK BEFORE THE MEETING

- ☐ Request and review all current IEP documents
- ☐ Review most recent progress reports and evaluations
- ☐ Write down your concerns and questions — rank them by priority
- ☐ Confirm who will attend and request an agenda in advance
- ☐ Arrange a support person or advocate to attend if desired
- ☐ If virtual: confirm platform (Teams, Zoom, etc.) and test your connection
- ☐ If virtual: request that a phone dial-in option be available as backup



- ☐ Request interpreter if needed — in your preferred language

Notes / Follow-up actions:

DAY BEFORE THE MEETING

- ☐ Organize all documents in a folder (physical or digital)
- ☐ Prepare a notepad for notes — or set up recording if permitted
- ☐ Write down your 3 non-negotiable priorities for this meeting
- ☐ Prepare something positive to share about your child
- ☐ If virtual: download/update the meeting app, test login
- ☐ Charge all devices if attending virtually
- ☐ Confirm the meeting link or call-in number

Notes / Follow-up actions:

DAY OF THE MEETING

- ☐ Arrive 5-10 minutes early (or log in early for virtual)
- ☐ Sign in — note who is present and their roles
- ☐ Ask for a copy of any documents being discussed
- ☐ Take notes throughout — dates, names, specific commitments made
- ☐ Do not feel pressured to sign anything you are not ready to agree to
- ☐ If virtual: use the chat function to note concerns in real time
- ☐ Ask for clarification on anything you don't understand
- ☐ Confirm next steps and timeline before the meeting ends

Notes / Follow-up actions:

AFTER THE MEETING

- ☐ Request a copy of the finalized IEP within 5 business days
- ☐ Send a follow-up email summarizing agreements made
- ☐ Note any unresolved concerns in writing to the school
- ☐ Set calendar reminders for next review date and goal check-ins
- ☐ If virtual: save or request a copy of the meeting recording if applicable
- ☐ File all documents in your child's IEP binder

Notes / Follow-up actions:



QUESTIONS YOU ALWAYS HAVE THE RIGHT TO ASK

- ☐ What data supports this recommendation?
- ☐ What alternatives were considered before this decision?
- ☐ How will we measure progress on this goal — and how often?
- ☐ Who is responsible for implementing this service?
- ☐ What happens if my child does not make adequate progress?
- ☐ Can I have that in writing? (Prior Written Notice)
- ☐ Can I have time to review this before I sign?
- ☐ Is this meeting being documented? How can I get a copy?
- ☐ If virtual: Can everyone see and hear clearly? Is anyone having technical issues?

My questions for this meeting:



DOWN SYNDROME — ADDITIONAL CHECKLIST ITEMS

Complete the universal checklist above AND address these disability-specific items:

- ☐ Review progress on communication and speech-language goals
- ☐ Ask about inclusion time in general education settings (LRE)
- ☐ Discuss sensory needs and environmental accommodations
- ☐ Address transition planning if child is 14+
- ☐ Ask about peer interaction and social skills programming
- ☐ Confirm related services in place: speech, OT, PT as appropriate
- ☐ Request specific data on goal progress — not just teacher observations
- ☐ Ask about community-based instruction opportunities
- ☐ Discuss adaptive physical education needs
- ☐ Ask about AAC (augmentative communication) if applicable

Notes / Concerns specific to this meeting:

AUTISM SPECTRUM DISORDER — ADDITIONAL CHECKLIST ITEMS

Complete the universal checklist above AND address these disability-specific items:

- ☐ Review sensory accommodations — are they being implemented consistently?
- ☐ Confirm whether a BIP is in place and being followed
- ☐ Ask for quantitative data on behavioral goals
- ☐ Discuss communication supports (AAC, PECS, visual schedules)
- ☐ Ask about social skills programming and peer support
- ☐ Review transition planning for college, vocational, or independent living
- ☐ Confirm that all staff working with your child are trained on autism strategies
- ☐ Address any upcoming changes in routine, staff, or environment
- ☐ Ask about sensory-friendly spaces and sensory breaks

Notes / Concerns specific to this meeting:

ADHD / OTHER HEALTH IMPAIRMENT — ADDITIONAL CHECKLIST ITEMS

Complete the universal checklist above AND address these disability-specific items:

- ☐ Review accommodations for attention, organization, and time management
- ☐ Confirm extended time is being implemented consistently by ALL teachers
- ☐ Ask about executive function supports (checklists, planners, visual schedules)



- ☐ Discuss homework modification policies
- ☐ Review behavioral supports — confirm positive reinforcement strategies
- ☐ Ask about preferential seating and movement breaks
- ☐ Confirm that all teachers (including electives) are implementing accommodations
- ☐ Address any medication-related protocols during school hours
- ☐ Ask about technology supports for note-taking and assignments

Notes / Concerns specific to this meeting:

SPEECH OR LANGUAGE IMPAIRMENT — ADDITIONAL CHECKLIST ITEMS

Complete the universal checklist above AND address these disability-specific items:

- ☐ Review frequency and duration of speech-language services
- ☐ Ask for data showing measurable progress on communication goals
- ☐ Discuss carry-over strategies in the classroom and at home
- ☐ Ask whether push-in or pull-out services are more appropriate
- ☐ Confirm that assistive technology has been considered (AAC, apps)
- ☐ Review pragmatic/social communication goals if applicable
- ☐ Ask about support for reading and writing if affected
- ☐ Confirm coordination between SLP and classroom teachers

Notes / Concerns specific to this meeting:

PHYSICAL / ORTHOPEDIC IMPAIRMENT — ADDITIONAL CHECKLIST ITEMS

Complete the universal checklist above AND address these disability-specific items:

- ☐ Review physical therapy and occupational therapy goals and frequency
- ☐ Confirm accessibility of ALL classrooms, restrooms, hallways, and common areas
- ☐ Ask about adaptive physical education
- ☐ Review transportation accommodations — specialized equipment if needed
- ☐ Discuss assistive technology for writing and classroom participation
- ☐ Confirm emergency evacuation plans address your child's specific needs
- ☐ Address fatigue management and scheduled rest breaks
- ☐ Review any medical protocols or health plans the school must follow
- ☐ Ask about positioning equipment and ergonomic supports

Notes / Concerns specific to this meeting:



MEETING NOTES

Key decisions made at this meeting:

Services/accommodations agreed to (include frequency and duration):

Items not resolved — follow up needed:

Commitments made by school (who said what, by when):

My concerns that were not addressed:

Next steps — what I need to do:

Date of next IEP review:

Remember: You Are a Required Member of This Team

Under IDEA, you are not a guest at IEP meetings — you are a required participant with equal standing. You have the right to request meetings, bring support persons, review all records, disagree with any part of the IEP, and take time before signing. Ask Ada any question at iepapproved.com — free, always.